

# ONDJ 2026/27 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 September 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v2.0 · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

**Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast**

The forecast leans toward above normal rainfall in the ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of above normal is 57%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 240 mm against a 1993/94–2024/25 average of 176 mm (+64 mm, +37%).



Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

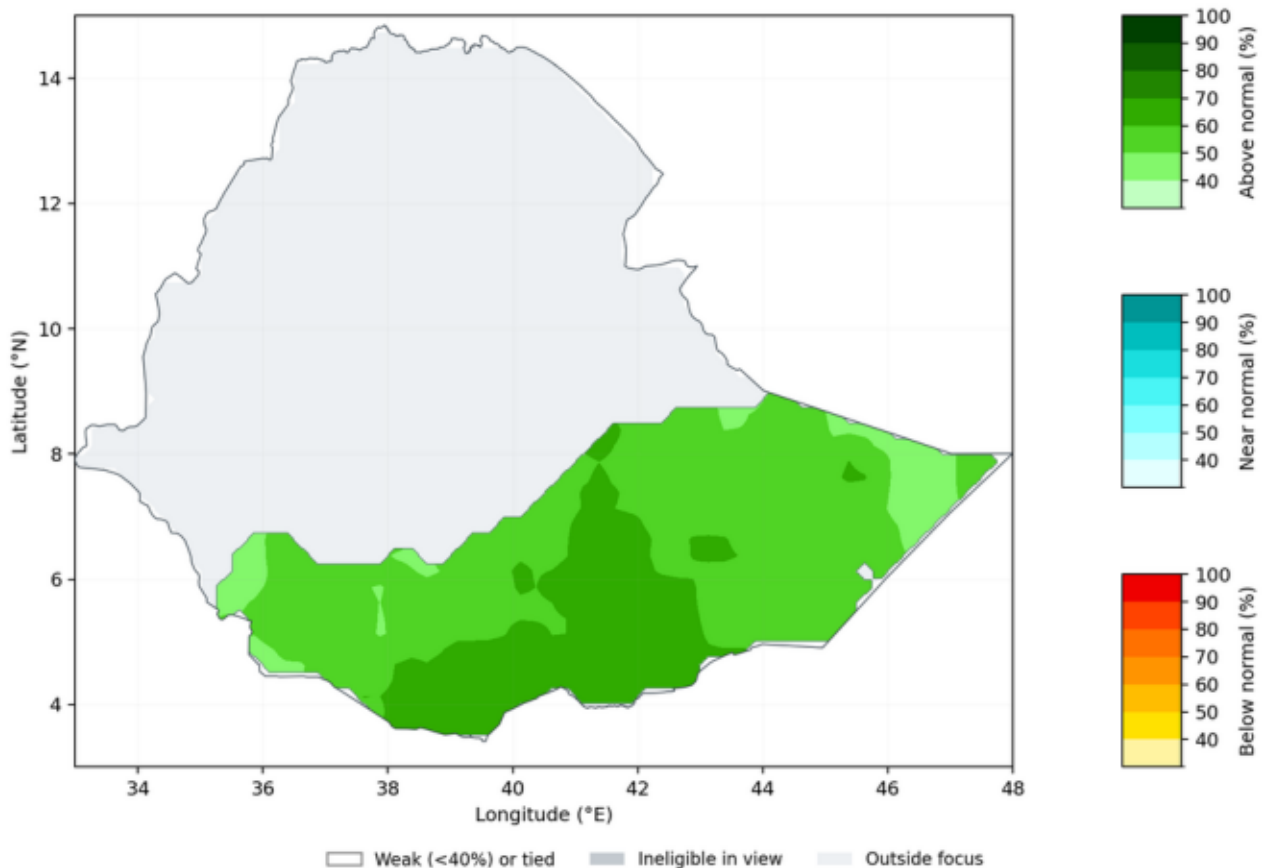
Forecast signal: Strong tilt toward above normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain): Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero). Probability skill (RPSS) +0.093, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval +0.012 to +0.182; better than climatology in 18 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.

## ONDJ 2026/27 | rainfall tercile outlook

September initialization · shared probability blend · CHIRPS reference 1993–2024

ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain · presentation layer



Display interpolation: 12x; Gaussian  $\sigma=0.6$  native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.  
Research reconstruction of a September-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

# All targets, evidence and record

ONDJ 2026/27 — September initialization · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

| Target       | Below/near/above | Coverage | Anomaly | Verification status                      |
|--------------|------------------|----------|---------|------------------------------------------|
| ONDJ 2026/27 | 19% / 24% / 57%  | 100%     | +64 mm  | Target period ongoing (ends 31 Jan 2027) |
| Oct 2026     | 27% / 30% / 43%  | 100%     | +20 mm  | Target period ongoing (ends 31 Oct 2026) |
| Nov 2026     | 21% / 22% / 57%  | 100%     | +31 mm  | Target period starts 1 Nov 2026          |
| Dec 2026     | 32% / 31% / 37%  | 54%      | +4 mm   | Target period starts 1 Dec 2026          |
| Jan 2027     | 29% / 37% / 34%  | 43%      | +2 mm   | Target period starts 1 Jan 2027          |

## Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

| Target | RPSS (95% interval)       | Yrs better | Holm p | In words                                                  |
|--------|---------------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| ONDJ   | +0.093 (+0.012 to +0.182) | 18/24      | 0.104  | Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero) |
| Oct    | +0.055 (−0.001 to +0.109) | 19/24      | 0.134  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain              |
| Nov    | +0.091 (−0.020 to +0.201) | 16/24      | 0.181  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain              |
| Dec    | +0.024 (−0.026 to +0.079) | 12/24      | 0.417  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain              |
| Jan    | +0.007 (−0.011 to +0.025) | 15/24      | 0.417  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain              |

## Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

No target has been verified yet.

### Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 September 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Oct 2026 – 31 Jan 2027

Forecast record: Generated 7 Oct 2026; not yet frozen for verification (freeze before observations are used)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 ONDJ 1993/94-2024/25 (32 seasons)

Observations processed through: None yet

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by\_month listing checked 10 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: Not run

Method / version: Shared climatology blend ( $\lambda = 0.28$  for ONDJ) · code b7a480a

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

# Monthly tercile outlooks

ONDJ 2026/27 — September initialization · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

